Practice workbook · How language and thinking develop: Piaget vs Vygotsky

Piaget's view that thought precedes language and Vygotsky's separate systems (pre-linguistic thought, pre-intellectual language).

9 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 8 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-LAN-01

1. Question 39 · part whole · 4 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 02

Worked-example retry · Attempt part whole only.

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39 Frances is seven months old. She is sitting in her high chair at the table. Her mother is feeding her food using a spoon. Frances shuts her mouth, shakes her head and knocks the spoon out of her mother's hand on to the floor.

At the same time her sister, Tamina, who is 18 months old, is given a cup of milk by her father. She takes the cup and gets up from the table. As Tamina is walking away from the table, she says 'cup' and then looks at the spoon and says 'spoon'.

Explain **two** ways Vygotsky's explanation of language and thought (1981) can account for Frances' and Tamina's actions.

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(Total for Question 39 = 4 marks)

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1. Question 39 · part whole · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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2. Question 39 · part whole · 2 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

39 Monica is a nine-month-old infant. Her grandmother visits the family and says 'hello' to Monica. She babbles at her grandmother in response. Later that day her father says to Monica 'it is time for bed' and she responds with the same babbles.

Explain the stage of language development that Monica is in.

You must use Vygotsky (1981) to justify your answer.

(Total for Question 39 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer

3. Question 41 · part whole · 4 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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41 Olly is given a new toy to play with. He already has a toy car and a bus, but his new toy is a truck. Olly is able to name his toy car and bus and can point to parts of the truck and name them, such as the wheels. He is not able to name the new toy as a 'truck'.

Explain **two** strengths of using Piaget's (1950) theory of language development to account for Olly's language skills.

Strength one:

Strength two:

(Total for Question 41 = 4 marks)

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3. Question 41 · part whole · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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4. Question 40 · part whole · 9 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

***40** Katie is playing a game with her 6-month-old daughter. Her daughter throws the rattle on the floor and each time Katie gives the rattle back. Her daughter repeats the action of throwing the rattle on the floor.

Katie's 18-month-old son Calvin points to the rattle each time it is thrown and says "rattle floor". Each time Katie returns the rattle to her daughter, Calvin says "rattle baby". He does not join in or ask his mother about the game.

Assess whether Vygotsky's (1981) explanation of language and thought can explain the actions of Katie's children.

(9)

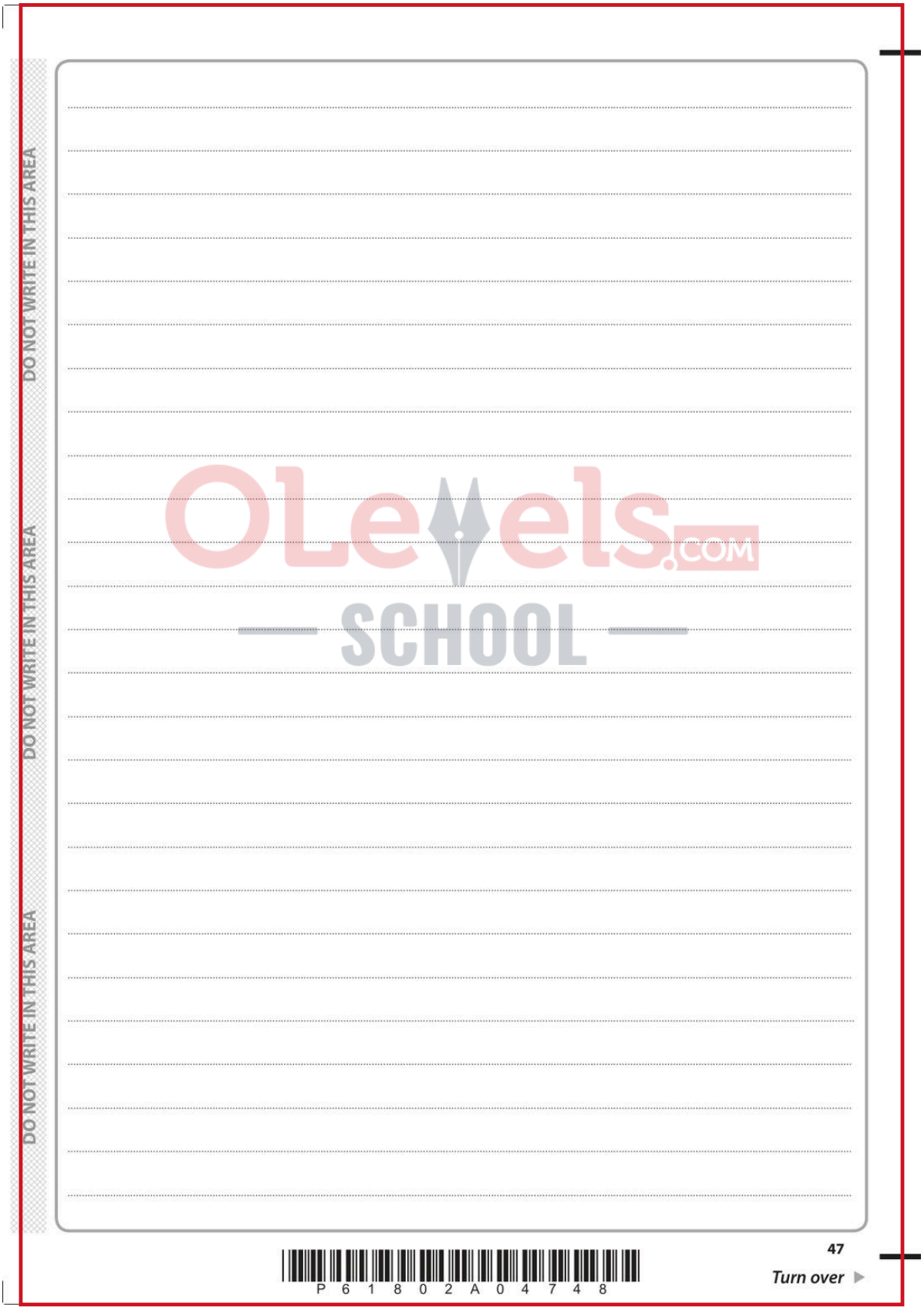
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4. Question 40 · part whole · 9 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.



4. Question 40 · part whole · 9 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.



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4. Question 40 · part whole · 9 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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5. Question 39 · part whole · 2 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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39 Percy is nine months old and has started uttering sounds such as 'bye', 'nah' and 'ta'. He repeats these throughout the day with no apparent reason for using the sounds.

Explain how pre-intellectual language can account for Percy's use of language.

(Total for Question 39 = 2 marks)

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

6. Question 40 · part whole · 9 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

***40** Anton is 18 months old and is learning to talk. He has started to name some objects when he sees them, such as 'teddy' and 'car'. Anton cannot name objects he is unfamiliar with. So, when his mother showed him a kettle, Anton was unable to say what it was. Anton can say the word 'mine' and he uses this word for all objects that he picks up.

When Anton's mum is talking to him, Anton smiles at her and often responds with random words. His mum asked Anton if he wanted custard with his cake, but Anton responded with the word 'car'.

Assess how well Piaget (1950) can explain the language development of Anton.

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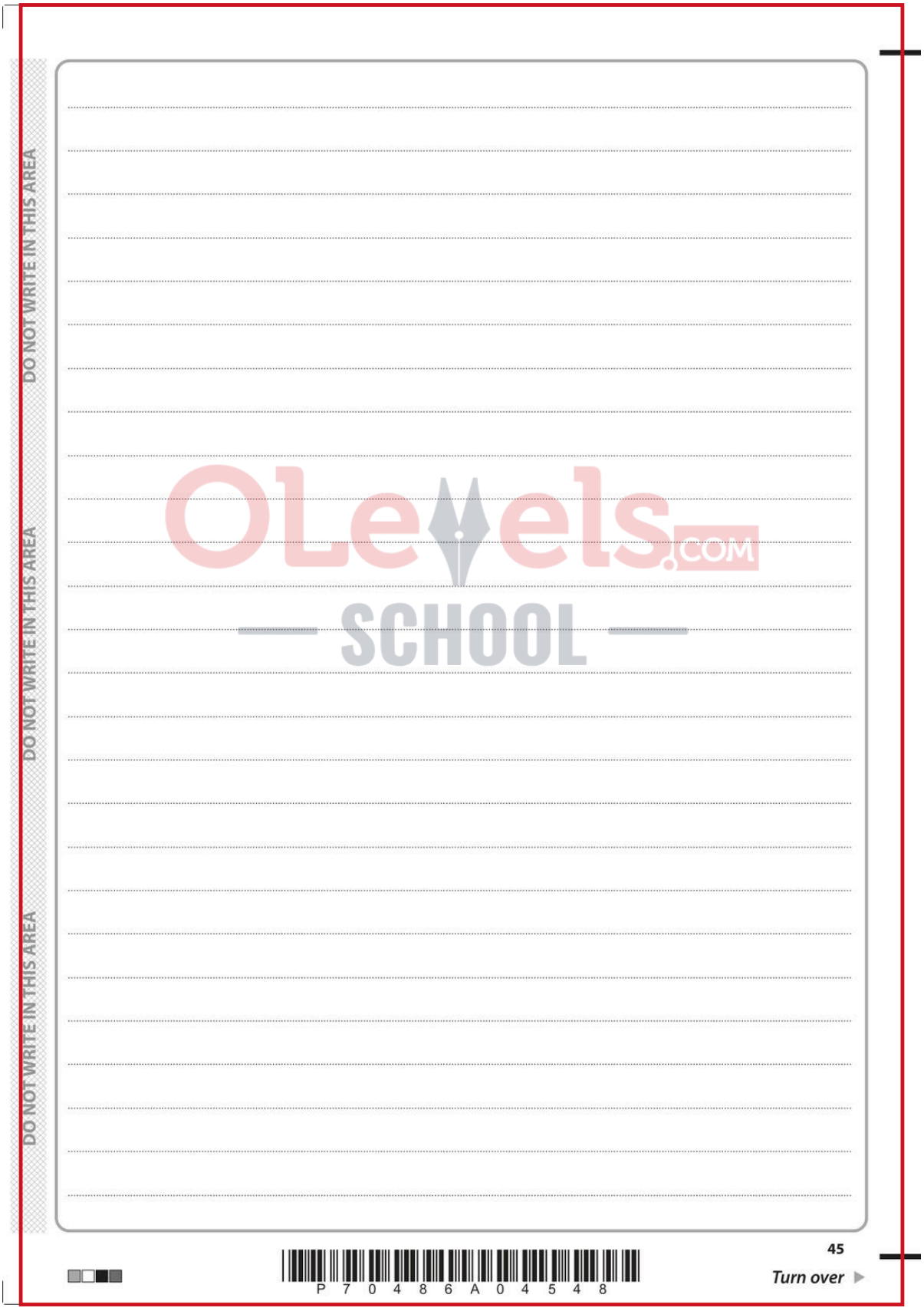
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6. Question 40 · part whole · 9 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.



6. Question 40 · part whole · 9 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.



6. Question 40 · part whole · 9 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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7. Question 38 · part whole · 2 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

38 Peter is nine months old. He is thirsty but cannot yet say the word 'thirsty' or 'drink'. Peter points to his drink and makes a squealing noise. Once his mother passes him the drink, he stops making the squealing noise.

Explain how Peter is able to understand that he needs a drink without having the language to say he is thirsty.

You must use Vygotsky (1981) to justify your answer.

(Total for Question 38 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer

8. Question 36 · part whole · 1 mark

2024 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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36 State what is meant by 'pre-linguistic thought'.

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(Total for Question 36 = 1 mark)

Working and answer

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9. Question 35 · part whole · 1 mark

2025 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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35 State what is meant by 'representational thinking'.

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(Total for Question 35 = 1 mark)

Working and answer

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